RuTAG

Rural Technology Action Group

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Rural Technology Action group (RuTAG)

Rural Technology Action Group or RuTAG is a brainchild of the Principal Scientific Advisor (PSA) to the Government of India. RuTAG was devised to be a mechanism to achieve rural advancement through S&T interventions. The interventions are essentially demand-driven and have focus on problems associated with marginal communities in rural areas.

FROM THE FITZGERALDS

At present, there are 7 RuTAG Centers located in the following IITs

- IIT Delhi
- IIT Bombay
- IIT Guwahati
- IIT Kanpur
- IIT Kharagpur
- IIT Madras
- IIT Roorkee

The office of the PSA also initiated RuTAG chapters attached to RuTAG Centers. The first chapter was opened a University of Jammu, attached to RuTAG IIT Delhi in 2014.

FROM THE FITZGERALDS

Need

Need for RuTAG As identified by the Office of the Prinicipal Scientific Adviser to the Government of India, India has remarkable potential to harness the benefits of technology for improving productivity of everyday life and livelihoods in rural areas.

FROM THE FITZGERALDS

Though many entities such as Central and State governmental agencies, S&T NGOs, voluntary agencies, Public Service Units (PSUs), Corporate Industrial Houses in Private Sector and other agencies are engaged in development and dissemination of technologies for rural development, the spread of rural technology has been diffused, uneven, and slow.
Its full potential for generating a rapid multiplier effect in the rural economy has remained unrealized.
Rural technology support is critical for realizing the vast potential of the rural farm and non-farm sectors.
Keeping the above aspects in view, the Office of Principal Scientific Advisor (PSA) to the Government of India conceptualised a mission called Rural Technology Action Group (RuTAG).
The RuTAG was conceived as a mechanism to provide a higher level of S&T intervention and support.

This intervention, which is demand-driven, could be for technology up-gradation, hi-tech delivery, technology training, demonstration, or any other innovative method.
Various Governmental agencies, district level administration, NGO's, Science & Technology oriented voluntary agencies, experts from modern industries and R&D institutes are picking up the common problems of a group of rural people, finding solutions and implementing them for the betterment of Rural areas of our country .
They do spend times for the betterment of rural masses.
These efforts have also got great success in many projects.

The scientists in the R&D institutions, the university system and the mission-oriented agencies have their own work.
However, most of them are not suited for implementations mainly due to lack of appropriate perspectives to the problems faced by the grass root people. Hence, the role of Rural Technology Action Group (RuTAG) becomes important who tries to define the problems clearly and seeks for solutions through Governmental, S&T NGOs, academic institutes (university system), other voluntary agencies and even corporate sectors.

THE FITZGERALDS

vision of RuTAG

The vision of RuTAG is to become an innovative rural technology development group comprising academicians, scientists, personnel from NGOs, Governmental agencies and technical institutes, traditional craftsmen and artisans, farmers and social entrepreneurs with a passion to serve the rural people.

FROM THE FITZGERALDS

Mission

To develop state-of-the-art science & technology resources, equipments, human resources and research facilities to innovate rural technologies by utilizing the existing and creative know-how with the involvement of people from rural areas and NGOs

THE OBJECTIVES

- To identify the problems and needs of the rural people by the way of direct surveys and interaction with NGOs working for rural people.
- To constitute a working group of innovators comprising academicians, scientists, personnel from NGOs, Governmental agencies and technical institutes, traditional craftsmen and artisans, farmers and social entrepreneurs

- To develop rural technologies to be used for various rural tasks, which can raise the life standard of the rural people.
- To study the existing traditional technology available with the villagers and refine it further for use at higher scale.
- To educate the rural people on rural technologies/skills development by way of conducting workshops, short term courses and formal/non-formal interactions from time-to-time.
- To develop the spirit of entrepreneurship within the rural people so that some of them can use their know-how and resources for setting-up small scale self-sustaining industries.
- To spread awareness towards making the planet greener and devising techniques to replace the non-green technology by greener and environmental friendly techniques.
- To involve and inspire the student fraternity to work for rural welfare.

Role of RuTAG

- Identify technology needs of the region
- Available technology solutions
- Problems encountered in adopting the existing technology at the grassroots.
- Identify R&D institutions that can improve the technology to suit the local conditions
- Assessment of the existing technology by relevant R&D institutions concerning the identified problems and finding a solution to overcome the technological problem.

- Conduct demonstration and training on the improved technology to the trainers for the target groups' large-scale adoption of the technology.

- Manufacturing and commercialization of the improved technology.
- Creating awareness of rural problems among the students and faculty of the university system and offering them guidance and financial support to come up with solutions to the grass-root problems
- Improve/upgrade/adapt the existing technology, conducting R&D/ modifications/re-designing/downsizing/fine-tuning/standardization/scientific validation for adoption of the technology by the users at the grassroots